

CASE BRIEF — OPERATION EARTHBOUND

Case Designation:	Operation Earthbound
Region:	Staffordshire, England
Classification:	Secret — CL 2+
Issuing Division:	Wayfinder — Research Wing
Date:	[Current Date]

SITUATION

A Covenant Wayfinder monitoring station detected an anomalous Corruption signature in rural Staffordshire. The signature pattern is consistent with a breached supernatural binding — ancient, Roman-era in origin. The epicenter is a farm. The farmer, one Arthur Dunn, is missing.

Local residents report unusual insect behavior, deteriorating water quality, and a spreading "quiet zone" in which ambient sound is perceptibly dampened. The signature is strengthening. HQ analysis suggests a containment pact of considerable age has been compromised. The binding's exact nature, the entity bound, and the mechanism of the pact are unknown at this time.

OBJECTIVES

- Primary:** Identify the binding mechanism and determine what was bound. Restore containment before full breach.
- Secondary:** Locate the missing farmer and determine his connection to the breach.
- Tertiary:** Secure any surviving documentation related to the original binding for Covenant archives.

KNOWN ORGANIZATIONS

ORGANIZATION	POSTURE	ASSESSMENT
The Birmingham Museum and Art Gallery	Unaware — holds related artifacts	The museum's Anglo-Saxon collection includes pieces recovered from the region. Some items may be connected to the binding. The museum is unaware of any supernatural significance.

The British Library	Unaware – holds relevant manuscripts	Manuscript holdings include early medieval chronicles and records that may reference local traditions or agreements from the period. Access requires a reader's card.
The Vatican Apostolic Archive	Unaware – holds relevant records	Known to retain records from the Roman administration of Britain. Access requires credentials or Church cooperation. Processing time is measured in weeks. The agents may not have weeks.
British Ministry of Agriculture	Dormant – will activate if symptoms become publicly visible	A quarantine or investigation would complicate operations. The Ministry is not hostile – it is doing its job. Its job will make the agents' job harder.

INITIAL LEADS

1. **Dunn's Farm, Staffordshire (L1):** The epicenter. Site examination may reveal the binding locus and evidence of what was disturbed. Exercise caution – the site emits Corruption.
2. **The Plough and Furrow Pub (L2):** Arthur Dunn's local. Patrons may have seen what he found or know where he went. Someone in the village knows more than they're saying – or less.
3. **Birmingham Museum and Art Gallery (L3):** The museum's Anglo-Saxon collection includes pieces recovered from the region. Curatorial records may identify items catalogued as anomalous, unrecovered, or inconsistently documented.
4. **The British Library, London (L4):** Manuscript holdings include early medieval chronicles. A search for references to pacts, bindings, or local traditions in the Staffordshire region during the Anglo-Saxon period may yield relevant information.

OPERATIONAL PARAMETERS

- **Rules of Engagement:** Standard containment with modification – the objective is restoration, not seizure. The binding is likely location-specific. Do not attempt to relocate or extract binding components without analysis confirming it is safe to do so.
- **Entity Protocol:** The bound entity cannot be fought, reasoned with, or bargained with. Do not attempt direct confrontation. Containment must be achieved through binding restoration, not force.
- **Auric Component:** Covenant analysis of the Corruption signature suggests an auric (gold) component to the binding mechanism. Any gold artifacts recovered from the epicenter region should be treated as potential binding elements. Do not remove gold from the region without authorization.

- **Corruption Hazard:** The binding locus emits ambient Corruption. Rotate agent exposure. Standard field decontamination protocols apply. Report any Corruption symptoms immediately.
- **Museum Protocol:** The Birmingham Museum's collection is legally protected. Any acquisition of collection items will be contested. The Covenant prefers diplomatic resolution. Escalation requires Watch Commander authorization.

REGIONAL CONTACTS

CONTACT	LOCATION	ACCESS
Dr. Margaret Rhys, retired archaeologist	Cottage in Wales	Former field director with extensive knowledge of regional Anglo-Saxon finds. Covenant affiliate. Happy to talk – few people ask about the old digs anymore.
Father Matteo, Vatican Apostolic Archive	Rome	Archivist for 22 years. Cooperative, curious, procedurally bound. Will help within the limits of his oath. Do not ask him to violate it.
Mr. Samuel Okonkwo, Birmingham Museum night security	Birmingham	Long-tenured staff member. Observant. May have noticed irregularities in the collection that daytime staff have dismissed.

This briefing contains information classified at Clearance Level 2. Distribution outside the assigned cell requires Watch Commander authorization. The binding is time-critical: the signature is strengthening. Do not delay.